



GREY BANNER ALERT

mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	28 March 2024	Time of Incident:	11:00am
Region / Directorate:	Goldfields Esperance	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Procedure Breach	EQSafe Incident Number:	39231
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Traffic Management Breach - Lab (core) Tester working within 1.2m of live traffic travelling 110km/h
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Executive Summary:

On Thursday 28 March 2024, a pre-start meeting commenced with the contractor's Traffic Management Coordinator and Traffic Controllers, who were advised that core testing had been scheduled to be undertaken at approx. 10:00am and to ensure a shadow vehicle / spotter was provided. The traffic management crew commenced setting up in accordance with the approved TGS.

During mid-morning, the contractor's Project Engineer learnt that the sub-contractor's primary core tester had departed site previous day due to a family emergency. The Project Engineer arrived at sub-contractor's Batch Plant and, along with sub-contractor's Operations Manager and Project Manager, and arranged for an alternative lab tester to attend site to undertake core testing.

The sub-contractor's core tester arrived at the testing location, facing northbound, located outside of the worksite and advised traffic control of his arrival. Traffic control provided a shadow vehicle to assist with the management of traffic travelling at a speed of 110 km per hour and four test holes were completed.

The core tester then proceeded to cross over to another testing location, facing southbound and prepared to core test another six test holes. During this time, the Traffic Management Coordinator advised the core tester to remain off the road and wait until traffic controllers returned. However, the core tester continued with testing.

The Project Engineer commenced departure at approx. 11:00am and observed the sub-contractor's core tester undertaking work without traffic management. The Project Engineer contacted traffic controllers via two-way radio and requested for the traffic management shadow vehicle to go back to the core testing work area.

A Main Roads officer heard concerns raised over the two-way, proceeded to drive to the location, confirmed at approx. 11:15am that the core tester was undertaking core testing without adequate traffic management controls in place, and reported this to the Traffic Management Coordinator. Site pack up commenced at 11:30am.

Investigation findings include:

- The speed reduction signs for the core testing failed to be set up in accordance with the approved TGS of the traffic management plan. The traffic controllers provided a shadow vehicle instead of setting up the speed reduction signs required for works to being undertaken within 1.2 metres of live traffic.

- Core testing is required to be completed within 24 hours of the asphalt being laid. The testing was required to be completed on the last day of the rostered swing. The core tester continued testing, despite being advised by Traffic Management to stay off the road. There was perceived time pressure to complete the testing to avoid an NCR.
- The Project Engineer departed site at approx. 11:00am, leaving the Traffic Management Coordinator to manage the core testing employee and the traffic control.

Incident Photos:



Worker standing behind vehicle undertaking core testing without traffic controller shadow vehicle or spotter

Contributing Factors:

- Time and productivity pressures occurred as the core testing was required to be completed within 24 hours of the asphalt being laid, which meant testing on the last day of the rostered swing.
- Faults identified with the coring drill potentially caused delay of the coring start time, resulting in less time to complete the task prior to departing for R&R.
- Supervision was deficient, due to scheduled departure times of the site supervisor and project engineer prior to the holiday break.
- The traffic controllers provided a shadow vehicle instead of setting up the speed reduction signs required for works to be undertaken within 1.2 of live traffic traveling at a speed of 110km per hour in accordance with the approved TGS-3 of the traffic management plan.
- Following instructions to correctly implement TGS-3, the core tester did not comply as they did not follow the communications of the traffic management coordinator to remain off the road until correct traffic management was implemented.
- The sub-contractor's worker who undertakes lab and core testing produced an old SWMS (revision 1 June 2022), initially signing onto the SWMS at the time of mobilising to the project (20 March 2024), however failed to review and sign onto the SWMS for the works undertaken on 28 March 2024.

Corrective Actions:

- The roster and the start and finish times are to be reviewed and amended to ensure workers are not under any perceived time pressures on last day of swing.
- The roster and the start and finish times are to be reviewed and amended to ensure adequate supervision and management of people and works.
- The correct TGS designed for testing activities must be implemented prior to commencing work.
- The SWMS are to be current, acknowledged by workers, and reviewed according to set procedures.

Additional Issues/Learnings:

- Positive communications between work teams are crucial to ensure a clear understanding of procedures and work instructions.

**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Interaction with Live Traffic.**

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations